

Once we are armed with these magic numbers and the information above, the manipulation of times and dates is no longer a problem. See the examples below (they all assume the time is in cell A1).

If you have the number 5.50 and you really want 5:30 or 5:30 AM use:

=A1/24 (and format as needed).

If it should be 17:00 or 5:30PM use:

=(A1/24)+0.5

To get the opposite, that is a decimal time from a true time, use

=A1*24

If a cell has both the true date and true time (e.g., 22/Jan/02 15:36) and we only want the date, use:

=INT(A1)

To get the time only use:

=TEXT(A1,'hh:mm:ss')*1, and format as needed.

To find out the difference between two dates use:

=DATEDIF(A1,A2,'d') where A1 is the earlier date. This will result in the number of days between two dates. It will also accept 'm' or 'y' as the result to return, that is, months or years.

If, when working with dates and times we cannot know in advance which date or time is the earliest we can use the MIN and MAX functions, for example we could use:

=DATEDIF(MIN(A1,A2),MAX(A1,A2),'d')

Also when working with times we may need to account for Start Time and End Time with the Start Time being 8:50 PM in cell